

ORSINO

Why, so I do, the noblest that I have:
 O, when mine eyes did see Olivia first,
 Methought she purged the air of pestilence!
 That instant was I turn'd into a hart;
 And my desires, like fell and cruel hounds,
 E'er since pursue me.

(Enter VALENTINE.)

How now! what news from her?

VALENTINE

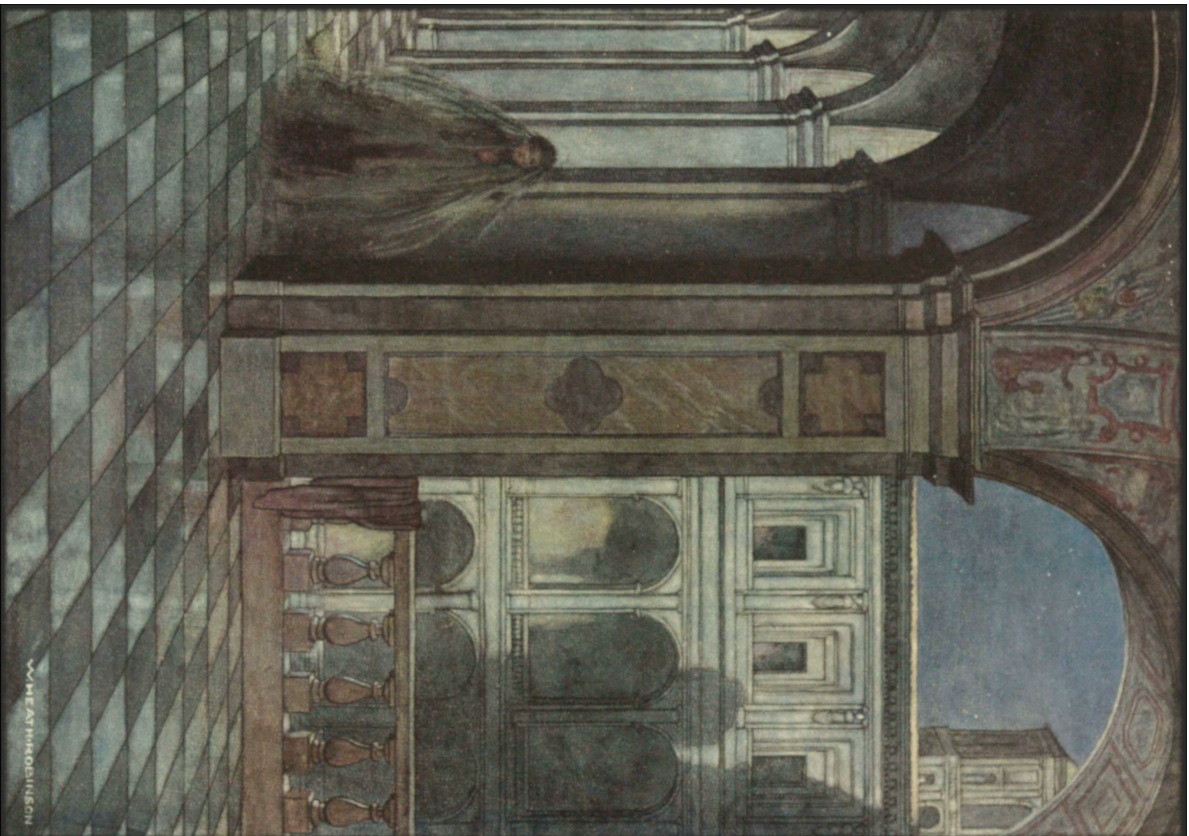
So please my lord, I might not be admitted;
 But from her handmaid do return this answer:
 The element itself, till seven years' heat,
 Shall not behold her face at ample view;
 But, like a cloistress, she will veiled walk
 And water once a day her chamber round
 With eye-offending brine: all this to season
 A brother's dead love, which she would keep fresh
 And lasting in her sad remembrance.

ORSINO

O, she that hath a heart of that fine frame
 To pay this debt of love but to a brother,
 How will she love, when the rich golden shaft
 Hath kill'd the flock of all affections else
 That live in her; when liver, brain and heart,
 These sovereign thrones, are all supplied, and fill'd
 Her sweet perfections with one self king!
 Away before me to sweet beds of flowers:
 Love-thoughts lie rich when canopied with bowers.
(Exeunt omnes.)



SO FULL OF SHAPES IS FANCY



Scene I

DUKE ORSINO'S palace

(Enter DUKE ORSINO, CURIO, and other Lords; Musicians attending)

ORSINO

If music be the food of love, play on;
Give me excess of it, that, surfeiting,
The appetite may sicken, and so die.
That strain again! it had a dying fall:
O, it came o'er my ear like the sweet sound,
That breathes upon a bank of violets,
Stealing and giving odour! Enough; no more:
'Tis not so sweet now as it was before.
O spirit of love! how quick and fresh art thou,
That, notwithstanding thy capacity
Receiveth as the sea, nought enters there,
Of what validity and pitch so'er,
But falls into abatement and low price,
Even in a minute: so full of shapes is fancy
That it alone is high fantastical.

CURIO

Will you go hunt, my lord?

ORSINO

What, Curio?

CURIO

The hart.

LIKE A CLOISTRESS, SHE WILL VEILED WALK



Scene 2

The sea-coast

(Enter VIOLA, a CAPTAIN and SAILORS.)

VIOLA

What country, friends, is this?

CAPTAIN

This is Illyria, lady.

VIOLA

And what should I do in Illyria?

My brother he is in Elysium.

Perchance he is not drown'd: what think you, sailors?

CAPTAIN

It is perchance that you yourself were saved.

VIOLA

O my poor brother! and so perchance may he be.

CAPTAIN

True, madam: and, to comfort you with chance,

Assure yourself, after our ship did split,

When you and those poor number saved with you

Hung on our driving boat, I saw your brother,

Most provident in peril, bind himself,

Courage and hope both teaching him the practise,

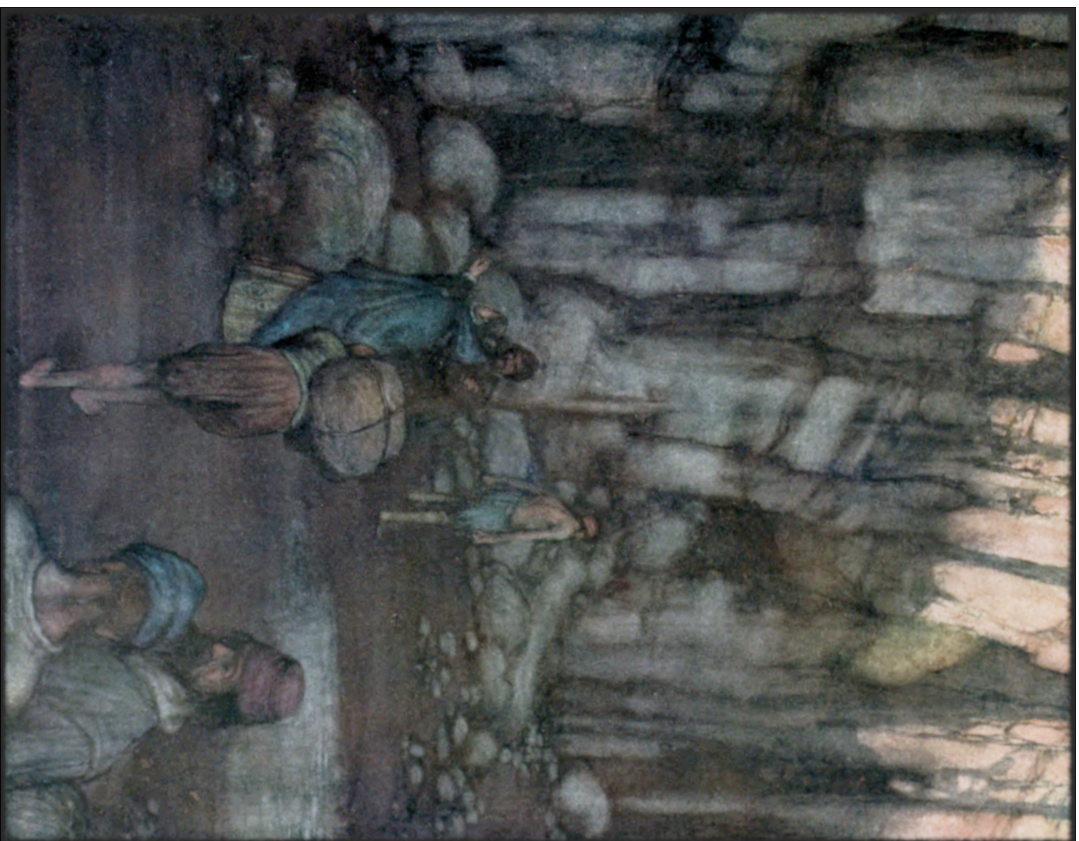
To a strong mast that lived upon the sea;

Where, like Arion on the dolphin's back,

I saw him hold acquaintance with the waves

So long as I could see.

O, WHEN MINE EYES DID SEE OLIVIA FIRST



WHAT COUNTRY, FRIENDS, IS THIS?



ACT I

VIOLA

For saying so, there's gold:
 Mine own escape unfoldeth to my hope,
 Whereto thy speech serves for authority,
 The like of him. Know'st thou this country?

CAPTAIN

Ay, madam, well; for I was bred and born
 Not three hours' travel from this very place.

VIOLA

Who governs here?

CAPTAIN

A noble duke, in nature as in name.

VIOLA

What is the name?

CAPTAIN

Orsino.

VIOLA

Orsino! I have heard my father name him:
 He was a bachelor then.

CAPTAIN

And so is now, or was so very late;
 For but a month ago I went from hence,
 And then 'twas fresh in murmur,—as, you know,
 What great ones do the less will prattle of,—
 That he did seek the love of fair Olivia.

VIOLA

What's she?

CAPTAIN

A virtuous maid, the daughter of a count
That died some twelvemonth since, then leaving her
In the protection of his son, her brother,
Who shortly also died: for whose dear love,
They say, she hath abjured the company
And sight of men.

VIOLA

O that I served that lady
And might not be delivered to the world,
Till I had made mine own occasion mellow,
What my estate is!

CAPTAIN

That were hard to compass;
Because she will admit no kind of suit,
No, not the duke's.

VIOLA

There is a fair behaviour in thee, captain;
And though that nature with a beauteous wall
Doth oft close in pollution, yet of thee
I will believe thou hast a mind that suits
With this thy fair and outward character.
I prithee, and I'll pay thee bounteously,
Conceal me what I am, and be my aid
For such disguise as haply shall become
The form of my intent. I'll serve this duke:
Thou shalt present me as an eunuch to him:
It may be worth thy pains; for I can sing
And speak to him in many sorts of music
That will allow me very worth his service.
What else may hap to time I will commit;
Only shape thou thy silence to my wit.

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Dramatis Personæ

VIOLA, a lady of Messaline shipwrecked on the coast of Illyria (later disguised as CESARIO)

OLIVIA, an Illyrian countess

MARIA, her waiting-gentlewoman

SIR TOBY BELCH, OLIVIA's kinsman

SIR ANDREW AGUECHEEK, SIR TOBY's companion

MALVOLIO, steward in OLIVIA's household

FOOL, OLIVIA's jester, named FESTE

FABIAN, a gentleman in OLIVIA's household

ORSINO, duke (or count) of Illyria

VALENTINE } gentlemen serving ORSINO
CURIO }

SEBASTIAN, VIOLA's brother

ANTONIO, friend to SEBASTIAN

CAPTAIN

PRIEST

TWO OFFICERS

LORDS, SAILORS, MUSICIANS, AND OTHER ATTENDANTS

CAPTAIN

Be you his eunuch, and your mute I'll be:

When my tongue blabs, then let mine eyes not see.

VIOLA

I thank thee: lead me on.

(*Exeunt omnes.*)

TWELFTH NIGHT
OR WHAT YOU WILL

William
Shakespeare



with
illustrations by
W. HEATH
ROBINSON

